MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CABLE, TELEPHONE WD-1A/TT (FIELD WIRE, PARALLEL PAIR)

This specification is approved for use by Communications Research and Development Command, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope.- This description covers stranded conductor, polyethylene insulated, parallel lay field telephone cable. Each conductor consists of seven strands; four of copper and three of steel.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issue of documents.- The following documents of the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

L-P-390	Plastic Molding and Extrusion Material, Polyethylene and Copolymers (Low, Medium and High Density).
QQ-W-343	Wire, Electrical and Non-electrical, Copper (Uninsulated).
QQ-W-461	Wire, Steel, Carbon (Round, Bare and Coated).
PPP-F-320	Fiberboard, Corrugated and Solid, Sheet Stock (Container Grade), and Cut Shapes.
PPP-T-97	Tape, Pressure-sensitive Adhesive, Filament Reinforced.

MILITARY

MIL-R-3241	Reels, Cable (Reels DR-5, DR-7, DR-15B, RL-159/U).
MIL-C-10369	Cable, Telephone, Field, For Rapid Payout (MX-306A/G).

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, US Army Communications Research and Development Command, ATTN: DRDCO-COM-RM-1, Fort Monmouth, New Jersey 07703, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC6145

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STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-228 Cable and Wire, Insulated, Methods of Testing.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

(Copies of documents required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer. Both the title and numer or symbol should be stipulated when requesting copies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.-

3.1.1 Copper strands.- Copper strands shall be tinned, soft or annealed copper wire in accordance with QQ-W-343. Each strand shall be 0.011 inch ± 5% in diameter.

3.1.2 Steel strands.- Steel strands shall be round steel wire 0.011 inch ± 5% in diameter. The wire shall be coated with a smooth, continuous, uniform and adherent zinc coating of commercially pure zinc (galvanized). The weight of zinc shall not be less than 25 grams of zinc per kilogram of coated strand. (See 4.5.2).

3.1.3 Insulating compound.- The insulating compound shall be black high density polyethylene or copolymer, Type III, Class H, Grade 1 in accordance with L-P-390 except that the carbon black shall be no greater than 2.5%.

3.2 Construction.-

3.2.1 Conductors.- Each conductor shall be composed of four coated copper strands and three coated steel strands.

3.2.1.1 Stranding.- The maximum length of lay of the strand conductor shall be one inch, and the direction of lay shall be left hand. The outside strands shall lie evenly and smoothly around the central strand without crowding. An antioxidant, such as Liquid Antox manufactured by E. I. duPont deNemours and Co., Inc.; Bayol 35 manufactured by Humble Oil and Refining Co.; MX-910 lub-oil manufactured by Mohawk Refining Co., or an equally satisfactory light oil, may be used as a lubricant in the stranding operation, in which case there shall be no excess oil on the finished stranded conductor.

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3.2.2 Insulation.- The pair of conductors shall be insulated with a tight well centered compound as specified in 3.1.3 with a minimum wall thickness of .014 inch when measured as specified in 4.5.1. The insulation on the separated conductors shall strip cleanly and readily with the use of pliers.

3.2.3 Finished cable characteristics.- The parallel pair cable shall consist of two conductors in parallel, commonly insulated in an approximate figure eight cross section. The finished cable shall be twisted right-lay (such as in a bunch strander) to make one twist per 12 inches when averaged over a 100 foot length. Separation of the conductors of the pair is accomplished by snipping the insulation at the end of the pair midway between the conductors and then tearing them apart. The tensile force necessary to separate the two wires shall be not less than one pound nor more than three pounds. When the conductors are separated in this fashion, the insulation shall not pull away from either conductor. No insulation repairs or wire splices shall be permitted in finished cable. The dimensions of the cable shall be as follows (see Figure 1):

Major axis	(A) 0.135 ± .005 inch	
Minor axis	(B) 0.070 ± .003 inch	
Conductor separation	(C) 0.033 ± .003 inch	(between inside surfaces of the conductors)
Conductor diameter	(D) 0.033 ± .003 inch.	

3.3 Physical condition.-

3.3.1 Insulated conductor.-

3.3.1.1 Tubing.- The insulated conductor shall show no visible strains or cracking of the insulation when tested as specified in 4.5.3.

3.3.1.2 Deformation.- The decrease in diameter of the insulated conductor when tested as specified in 4.5.4 shall not exceed 15%.

3.3.1.3 Cold bend.- The insulated conductor shall not crack when tested as specified in 4.5.5 and 4.5.5.1.

3.3.1.4 Cutting.- The average cutting load shall be not less than 55 pounds, and the cutting load for any one specimen shall be not less than 45 pounds. (See 4.5.6).

3.3.1.5 Breaking load.- The breaking load shall be measured on the completed cable and shall not be less than 170 pounds. (See 4.5.7).

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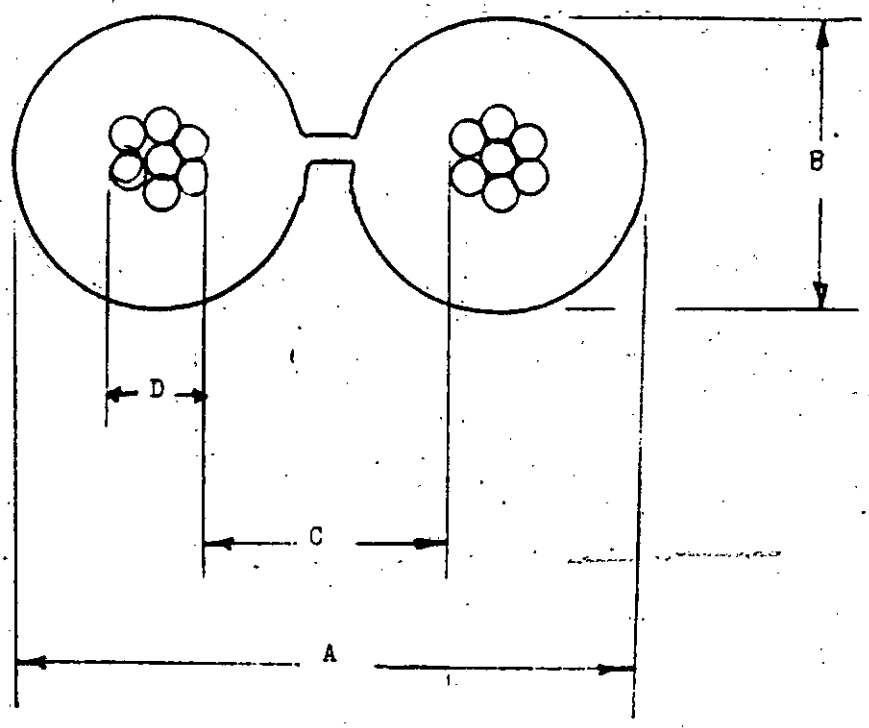


Figure 1

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3.4 Performance.- Finished field wire, wound on its final shipping reel, spool, or dispenser, as applicable, shall meet the following requirements.

3.4.1 DC resistance.- The direct current (dc) resistance of field wire, at or corrected to 20°C, shall not exceed 46 ohms per 1,000 loop-feet. (See 4.5.8).

3.4.2 Dielectric strength.- Field wire shall withstand a potential of 1,000 volts root-mean-square. (See 4.5.9).

3.4.3 Insulation resistance.- Insulation resistance of field wire, at or corrected to 15.6°C, shall be not less than 10,000 megohms per 1,000 single conductor feet. (See 4.5.10).

3.4.4 Attenuation.- The attenuation of each pair shall be no greater than shown in Figure 2 when measured both wet and dry as specified in 4.5.11. The dry readings shall be no more than 30% below the wet readings.

3.4.5 Crosstalk.- The crosstalk shall be at least 55 db down when measured as specified in 4.5.12.

3.5 Flatness.- Field wire shall lie flat and straight when uncoiled from a reel or a spool or dispenser into a level surface. (See 4.5.13).

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection.- Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Classification of inspections.- The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

(a) Inspections covered by subsidiary documents. (See 4.3).

(b) Quality conformance inspections. (See 4.4).

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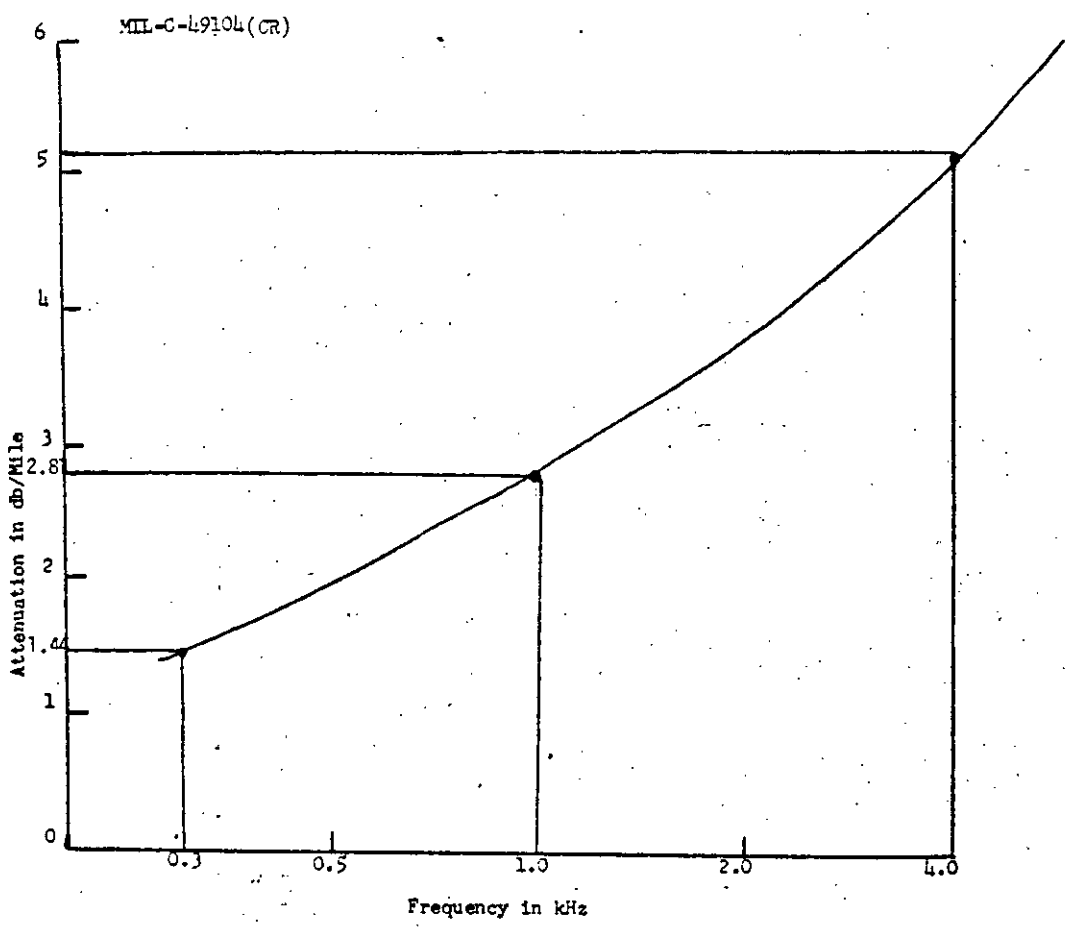


Figure 2

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4.3 First article.- Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the first article inspection shall be performed by the contractor.

4.3.1 First article units.- The contractor shall furnish two (2) one mile lengths of finished cable WD-1A each mile wound on Reel DR-5 as a sample for approval, if required by the invitation for bids or contracts.

4.3.2 First article inspection.- The first article inspection shall consist of the inspections specified in subsidiary documents covering the items in 4.3 and the inspections specified in Tables I, II and III.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection of equipment before preparation for delivery.- The contractor shall perform the inspections specified in 4.3, 4.4.1 through 4.4.2 and 4.5. This does not relieve the contractor of his responsibility for performing any additional inspection which is necessary to control the quality of the product and to assure compliance with all specification requirements.

4.4.1 Group A inspection.- Group A inspection shall consist of the examinations and tests specified in Table I. An inspection lot shall consist of all units of product of one type produced under substantially the same conditions and offered for inspection at one time. Each lot shall be subject to sampling inspection in accordance with MIL-STD-105 for general inspection level II. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be as specified in Table I. For inspection purposes a unit shall be that quantity required to be wound on Reel RL-159/U.

Table I.- Group A inspection

Inspection	Reqt Para	Insp Para	AQL % defective
Visual and dimensional	3.2	4.5.1	1.0% major
DC resistance	3.4.1	4.5.8	4.0% minor/all electrical defects are major
Dielectric strength	3.4.2	4.5.9	
Insulation resistance	3.4.3	4.5.10	

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4.4.2 Group B inspection.- Group B inspection shall normally be performed on inspection lots that have passed Group A inspection and on samples selected from units that have been subjected to and met the Group A inspection. This inspection shall conform to Table II and to the special inspection levels of Table I of MIL-STD-105.

4.4.2.1 Group B sampling plans.- The Group B AQLs shall be 1.0 percent defective and the inspection levels shall be S-3.

4.4.2.2 Order of inspection within Group B.- Group B inspection shall be in an order satisfactory to the Government.

Table II.- Group B inspection

Inspection	Reqt Para	Insp Para	AQL (% defective)
Coating	3.1.2	4.5.2	4.0 for the group
Tubing	3.3.1.1	4.5.3	
Deformation	3.3.1.2	4.5.4	
Cold bend	3.3.1.3	4.5.5	
Cutting	3.3.1.4	4.5.6	
Breaking load	3.3.1.5	4.5.7	
Attenuation	3.4.4	4.5.11	
Crosstalk	3.4.5	4.5.12	
Flatness	3.5	4.5.13	

4.5 Methods of examination and tests.-

4.5.1 Visual and dimensional examination.- Field wire shall be examined to verify that the characteristics listed in Table III are in accordance with the applicable requirements. The examinations and measurements specified in Table III shall be made on specimens not less than 2 feet in length and cut no closer than 5 feet from the end of the sample unit. The examinations and measurements shall be made as specified in Table III.

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Table III- Visual and dimensional examination

Examination	Req't Para	Test Method
Construction:		
Conductors	3.2.1	
Stranding	3.2.1.1	FED-STD-228, Method 1531
Insulation (.014" min)	3.2.2	FED-STD-228, Method 1018 1/ 2/
Finished cable characteristics	3.2.3	

1/ An average diameter shall be considered to be the average of the readings obtained by making two measurements at right angles to each other at three different points along the length of a 12-inch specimen.

2/ The average wall thickness shall be considered equal to one-half the difference between the average diameter of the insulated conductor and the non-insulated conductor for the same specimen.

4.5.2 Coating (See 3.1.2).- The weight, uniformity, and adherence of zinc coating on steel strands shall be determined as specified in the tests for weight of tin or zinc coating, uniformity of zinc coating (Preece method), and adherence of zinc coating for classes 1, 2 and 3 wire of QQ-W-461, with the following modifications of the Preece method:

(a) All specimens shall withstand at least one immersion.

(b) Uniformity shall be determined on three specimens from each sample unit of strand, and the time of immersion shall be 15 + 1, -0 seconds. The coating shall be considered uniform if all three specimens withstand the same number of immersions ± 1 before the end point is reached.

4.5.3 Tubing.- The specimen (insulated conductor) shall be looped back and wound tightly on itself for five close turns. The ends shall be securely taped, and the specimen shall be placed in an air oven maintained at a temperature of 95° ± 1°C for 1 hour + 5, -0 minutes. The specimen shall then be removed from the oven and the insulation examined for strains or cracks under a magnification of at least three diameters (focal distance 8 centimeters (cm)). (See 3.3.1.1).

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4.5.4 Deformation.- The gage shall consist of a dial micrometer graduated to read in increments of 0.001 inch and equipped with a flat anvil not less than 0.375 inch in diameter and a flat pressure foot 0.375 ± 0.001 inch in diameter attached to a plunger. The anvil and pressure foot shall be parallel to within 0.0001 inch. The plunger shall be designed to support a weight of 250 grams. The gage shall be placed in an oven maintained at a temperature of 95° ± 1°C for a period of 1 hour + 5, -0 minutes. A specimen of insulated conductor at room temperature shall then be placed on the platform, centrally located under the foot, and its diameter shall be read exactly 5 seconds after being so placed. The gage and specimen shall then remain in the oven for a period of 1 hour + 5, -0 minutes at the above temperature and the diameter of the specimen again read without disturbing the specimen or gage. (See 3.3.1.2).

4.5.5 Cold bend.- The specimen of insulated conductor and a mandrel of 0.080 ±0.003 inch diameter for insulated conductor shall be placed in a cold chamber maintained at a temperature of -40° ± 1°C for a period of 24 +4, -0 hours. At the end of this time, while still in the cold chamber, the specimen shall be wound around the mandrel for five close turns at the rate of approximately one turn per second. The specimen shall then be examined under a magnifying glass at least three diameters magnification (focal distance 8 cm) for visible evidence of cracking of the insulation. During the above processing, no object having a temperature higher than -40° ± 1°C shall come within 12 inches of the part of the specimen being examined. (See 3.3.1.3).

4.5.5.1 After aging.- A specimen of insulated conductor shall be dried in an air oven for a period of at least 24 hours at 80° ± 1°C and then transferred directly (within 5 minutes) from the air oven to an oxygen bomb containing an atmosphere of oxygen at 300 ± 10 pounds per square inch at a temperature of 70° ± 1°C, and held there for a period of 96 + 2, -0 hours. Alternately, the specimen may be transferred directly to a desiccator containing a drying agent to preclude re-absorption of water and then to the oxygen bomb when the bomb is available. After 96 + 2, -0 hours in the oxygen bomb, the specimen shall be transferred directly to a desiccator containing a drying agent, and held there for at least 24 hours and until such time as the specimen is transferred directly to a cold chamber. The conditioned specimen shall then be tested as specified in 4.5.5.

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4.5.6 Cutting.- A specimen of insulated conductor shall be cut in half, and the insulation stripped from one end of each piece. One piece shall be formed into a loop, the ends of which shall be tightly clamped in one of the grips of a tensile tester. The second piece shall be passed through the loop and its ends shall be tightly clamped in the other grip of the tensile tester. The two bared ends shall be connected in series with an electrical alarm circuit and a load shall be applied to the looped conductors by separation of the jaws at a rate of 2 inches per minute until they cut through the insulation, thus making electrical contact as indicated by the electrical alarm. One of the metal grips of the tensile machine may have to be electrically insulated from the rest of the machine to avoid false indications. (See 3.3.1.4).

4.5.7 Breaking load.- The breaking load or tensile strength, as applicable, shall be determined using the apparatus and method described in Method 3211 of FED-STD-228. (See 3.3.1.5).

4.5.8 Dielectric strength (see 3.4.2).- The dielectric strength of field wire shall be determined as specified in Method 6111 of FED-STD-228, except that:

(a) The immersion period shall be 4 hours.

(b) One terminal shall be both conductors connected together, and the other shall be the water.

4.5.9 Insulation resistance (see 3.4.3).- The insulation resistance of field wire shall be determined after dielectric strength (See 4.5.8) as specified in Method 6031 of FED-STD-228, except that:

(a) The immersion period shall be 4 hours.

(b) The test voltage shall be not less than 100 volts dc.

(c) The polarity of the conductors shall be maintained negative with respect to the water.

(d) One terminal shall be both conductors connected together, and the other shall be the water.

(e) For purposes of computation, twice the field wire footage shall be taken as the length of conductor under test.

(f) If the measurement is made at a temperature other than 15.6°C, the manufacturer shall correct the measured value of insulation resistance to the resistance at 15.6°C. However, if the insulation resistance is equal to or greater than that required by 3.4.3, when the measurement is made at a temperature greater than 15.6°C, no correction factor need be employed. The manufacturer shall demonstrate that the correction factor is accurate for his compound.

(g) The insulation resistance test may be terminated in less than one minute if the galvanometer has ceased fluctuating and the reading indicates that steady insulation resistance value has been obtained. However, readings

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obtained on 5% of the lengths after 1-minute electrification shall be recorded to establish a continuous check of quality.

4.5.10 DC resistance.- The dc resistance of field wire shall be determined after dielectric strength (See 4.5.8) as specified in Method 6021 of FED-STD-228, except that the immersion period shall be 4 hours. (See 3.4.1).

4.5.11 Attenuation.- The attenuation of the pair shall be measured on a fifty (50) foot length of cable and computed to db per mile. The wet readings shall be taken on cable which has been in water at least 96 hours. Measurements shall be taken at frequencies of 300 hertz, 1 kilohertz, and 4 kilchertz to establish compliance with 3.4.4. If individual readings do not comply, several samples shall be measured and an average taken. The attenuation shall be calculated from direct measurements of the parameters R, L, C, and G and using the standard formula for the attenuation of a two wire transmission line as follows:

$$S = 8.69\sqrt{1/2\left(\sqrt{(R^2+W^2L^2)\ (G^2+W^2C^2)}\ +RG-W^2LC\right)}\quad \text{db/mile}$$

Where attenuation is in decibels per mile, 8.69 is a factor to convert nepers to decibels.

R = Resistance in ohms per mile
L = Inductance in henries per mile
C = Capacitance in farads per mile
G = Conductance in mhos per mile
W = $2\pi f$ and f = frequency in hertz

4.5.12 Crosstalk.- The crosstalk of the cable shall be measured on two lengths of cable, one mile long, and taped together at approximate one foot intervals. Referenced measurement to be made on near end. The two cables shall not be twisted together while taping. Crosstalk shall then be measured with the cable strung aerially and laid on the ground. Both ends of the cable may be brought back to the same point for ease in testing. The 600 ohm non-wirewound resistors shall be connected between conductors at the terminal ends of each pair in the two pair assembly except on the cable end which is to be used for the disturbing signal. This signal shall be applied using an oscillator set at 600 ohms internal output impedance. Readings at 0.3, 1, and 4 kilohertz shall be taken of the amount of signal received in the other (disturbed) pair in db below the disturbing signal. (See 3.4.5).

4.5.13 Flatness.- One hundred feet of field wire shall be pulled from a reel or spool or dispenser, as applicable, and allowed to lie free on a flat floor. With no strain on the free end, a point along the wire 3 feet from the free end shall be not less than 96 feet from the original 100-foot mark on the wire. (See 3.5).

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4.5.14 Conductor separation. The specimen shall be subjected to a tensile force necessary to separate the two wires and shall be determined using the apparatus and method described in Method 302/ of FED-STD-228. The specimen shall meet the requirements of 3.2.3.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A, B or commercial, as specified (see 6.( )).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Cleaning. Cable, Telephone (Field Wire, Parallel Pair WD-1A/TT) shall be cleaned in accordance with process C-1 of MIL-P-116.

5.1.1.2 Drying. Cable, Telephone (Field Wire, Parallel Pair WD-1A/TT) shall be dried in accordance with the applicable procedure of MIL-P-116.

5.1.1.3 Preservative application. None required.

5.1.1.4 Unit packing. Unit packing shall be in accordance with the methods prescribed in MIL-P-116 as specified herein.

5.1.1.4.1 Wire on Reels RL-159( )/U or DR-5. Wire on Reels RL-159( )/U or DR-5 shall be individually unit packed method III as follows: Wire, in the required length, shall be fully and evenly wound on each reel. Secure the outside end of the wire to the adjacent turn of wire. The inside end of the wire, previously extended outside the reel for testing, shall be cut back to one foot and pushed through the oval access hole into the center of the reel. Each reel with wire shall be overwrapped with one thickness of fiberboard conforming to PPP-F-320, type SF, class weather-resistant, grade V3s, of sufficient width to extend the full distance between the reel flanges and of sufficient length to overlap the ends with a minimum of six inches. The fiberboard overwrap shall be secured with two bands of reinforced filament tape conforming to PPP-T-97, type IV, equally spaced between the reel flanges for RL-159( )/U. The overwrap on Reel DR-5 shall be secured with two bands of flat steel strapping conforming to QQ-S-781, class 1, type I, finish A.

5.1.1.4.2 Wire on Spool DR-8-A. Wire on Spools DR-8-A shall be individually unit packed method III as follows: Wire in the required length shall be fully and evenly wound on the spool. Both ends of the wire shall be firmly secured. Place each spool within a close-fitting fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, W5c. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the box specification.

5.1.1.4.3 Wire Dispenser MX-306( )/G with wire. Dispenser MX-306( )/G with wire shall be unit packed method III as follows: Wire in the required length positioned inside the dispenser shall be placed within a close-fitting fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, V3c. A liner made of fiberboard conforming to PPP-F-320, type CF, class weather-resistant, grade W5c, shall be fabricated and applied in conformance with PPP-B-636. Closure of the box shall be in accordance with the appendix of the box specification.

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5.1.2 Level B. Cleaning, drying, preservative application and unit packing shall be as specified in 5.1.1.

5.1.3 Commercial preservation. Preservation shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or commercial, as specified (see 6.2). Shipping containers for level A and B shall be capable of stacking and supporting superimposed loads during shipment and storage without damaging the container(s) or its contents.

5.2.1 Level A. A quantity of Wire on Reels RL-159( )/U, DR-5; Wire Dispenser MX-306( )/G or Spools DR-8, unit packed as specified in 5.1, shall be packed within a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, style 4, class 2; or PPP-B-585, style 2 or 3, class 3. When the gross weight exceeds 200 pounds or the container length and width is 48 x 24 inches or more and the weight exceeds 100 pounds, 3 x 4 inch skids, laid flat, shall be applied in accordance with the requirements of the container specification, or if not specified in the specification, in a manner which will adequately support the item and facilitate the use of material handling equipment. Closure and strapping shall be in accordance with the applicable container specification or appendix thereto except that metal strapping shall conform to QQ-S-781, type I, finish A.

5.2.2 Level B. Wire on Reels RL-159( )/U, DR-5; Wire Dispenser MX-306( )/G or Spools DR-8 shall require no further packing. A quantity of reels, dispensers or spools, unit packed as specified in 5.1 and bearing the same stock number, shall be palletized in accordance with MIL-STD-147.

5.2.3 Commercial packing. Packing shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Military marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packs and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.3.2 Commercial marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packs and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

6. NOTES

6.1 Unless otherwise specified, a specimen shall consist of a sample length of cable no less than two feet in length.

6.2 Level A, level B or commercial preservation and packing (see section 5).

6.3 When rough handling test is required.

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6.4 Environmental. Environmental pollution prevention measures are contained in the packaging material specifications referenced herein. Refer to material specifications or preparing activity for recommended disposability methods.

CUSTODIAN

ARMY (CR)

Preparing Activity

ARMY - CR

Project No. 6145-A041

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-C-49104 (CR)

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ATTN: DRDCO-CM-DM
Fort Monmouth, NJ 07703

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

TELEPHONE NO.

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